National Cafe Lead Role & Responsibilities

Applicable Centres

All BAPS Australia Centres.

Business Arm

BAPS Shayona

Position Level

National

Reports to

National Admin - Shayona

Version Control

Version	Date	Author / Owner	Approved by	Summary of Changes
1.0	14/02/2026	National Shayona team	Pujya Paramchintan Swami	Initial Draft

Café Lead (National)

The National Café Lead is responsible for the strategic development, operational standardisation, and performance oversight of BAPS Shayona's Café operations across Australia. Reporting to the National Admin BAPS Shayona, they lead the development of the Café concept, menu, and service standards, provide guidance to local Café leads, and drive the long-term growth and expansion of the Café offering. They work closely with Shared Services — including Sourcing & Imports, QA, and Finance — to ensure all Café operations are commercially sound, sattvic compliant, and reflective of BAPS Shayona's values of quality, warmth, and seva.

Café Concept and Menu Development

- **Café Concept:**
  - Define and evolve the national BAPS Shayona Café concept, including brand identity, atmosphere, and customer experience standards.
  - Ensure the Café concept is consistent across all existing and future locations while allowing for contextually appropriate local variation.
  - Stay informed of relevant food and beverage industry trends and community preferences to keep the Café offering fresh and appealing.
- **Menu Development:**
  - Develop, maintain, and regularly review the national Café menu, ensuring all items meet BAPS sattvic standards.
  - Standardise recipes, presentation, portion sizes, and preparation guidelines across all Café locations.
  - Introduce seasonal specials, new product lines, and limited-time offerings in consultation with local leads and the Kitchen team.
  - Ensure all menu items are clearly documented with ingredients, allergen information, and pricing.
- **Pricing Strategy:**
  - Develop and maintain a national Café pricing framework that is commercially viable, consistent, and accessible to the BAPS community.
  - Review pricing periodically in line with supplier costs, market conditions, and the national budget.

Service Standards and Training

- **Service Standards:**

- Define and communicate national Café service standards, covering customer greeting, order management, presentation, speed of service, and complaint resolution.
- Ensure all Café locations are delivering a consistently high-quality and welcoming experience to all customers and haribhakto.
- Promote a culture of respect, warmth, and genuine seva in all customer-facing interactions.

- **Training and Development:**
  - Develop national training materials and guidelines for Café volunteers and leads, covering product knowledge, service standards, food handling, and hygiene.
  - Coordinate onboarding and training for new Café volunteers across all locations.
  - Support local leads in upskilling their teams and maintaining consistent service delivery.
  - Encourage other potential volunteers' participation in Café seva across all locations.
- **Food Safety and Compliance:**
  - Ensure all Café operations hold and maintain current food safety certifications and comply with relevant state and national food safety regulations.
  - Work with the QA Lead (Shared Services) to implement and monitor food safety and hygiene standards across all Café locations.
  - Conduct or facilitate periodic compliance audits across all Café operations.

Supplier and Product Sourcing

- **Supplier Coordination:**
  - Work with Sourcing & Imports (Shared Services) to identify, evaluate, and manage suppliers for all Café-specific products and ingredients.
  - Ensure all Café suppliers meet BAPS sattvic standards, food safety requirements, and quality benchmarks.
  - Review supplier performance periodically and recommend changes where necessary.
- **Product Sourcing:**
  - Coordinate the national procurement of Café-specific products, including beverages, ingredients, packaging, and equipment.
  - Monitor stock levels and coordinate replenishment to ensure consistent product availability across all Café locations.
  - Support local leads in managing local stock requirements for the Café operation.

Expansion and Growth Planning

- **Expansion Planning:**

- Develop and maintain a national Café expansion strategy, identifying future locations across existing and new BAPS centres.
- Prepare business cases and feasibility assessments for new Café locations in consultation with the National Admin BAPS Shayona and the Board.
- Coordinate the setup and launch of new Café locations, including fit-out requirements, equipment, volunteer resourcing, and operational readiness.

- **Growth Initiatives:**
  - Identify opportunities to grow Café revenue and community engagement through new products, extended trading, events, and promotions.
  - Coordinate with Nativ Farms Social Media and Sales & Marketing leads to promote the Café offering to the broader community.
  - Explore partnerships and initiatives that align with BAPS Shayona's values and growth objectives.

Leadership and Coordination

- **Local Lead Support:**
  - Provide strategic direction, operational guidance, and ongoing support to all local Café leads.
  - Conduct regular check-ins with local leads to review performance, challenges, and priorities.
  - Support local leads in volunteer management, rostering, and team development.
  - Foster a national culture of Samp, Suhradbhav, and Ekta across all Café volunteer teams.
- **Vimarsh:**
  - Organise and chair a regular National Café Vimarsh with all local Café leads.
  - Prepare and distribute meeting agendas prior to each vimarsh.
  - Ensure accurate minutes are recorded and distributed following each meeting.
  - Compile and escalate key matters from local vimarsh reports to the National Admin BAPS Shayona.
- **Cross-Vertical Coordination:**
  - Coordinate with Sourcing and Imports for raw materials sourcing and imports.
  - Coordinate with the Hall Hire & Catering Lead for integrated event delivery where Café services are involved.
  - Coordinate with Finance for Café financial reporting, invoicing, and chargeback management.

Performance Benchmarking and Reporting

- **Performance Metrics:**
  - Define and monitor national KPIs for all Café operations, including revenue, customer volume, product performance, service standards, food safety compliance, and volunteer engagement.
  - Review performance data from local leads and identify trends, gaps, and opportunities for improvement.
  - Benchmark performance across Café locations and share insights to drive continuous improvement.
- **Customer Satisfaction:**
  - Establish and maintain a consistent process for collecting and reviewing customer feedback across all Café locations.
  - Address escalated customer concerns and implement operational improvements based on recurring feedback themes.
- **Reporting:**
  - Prepare and submit a consolidated monthly Café performance report to the National Admin BAPS Shayona, covering financial performance, operational highlights, customer feedback, and key issues.
  - Provide recommendations for growth, improvement, and resource requirements as part of regular reporting.

Administration

- **Policy and Documentation:**
  - Maintain a centralised repository of all national Café policies, guidelines, menus, recipes, and standard operating procedures.
  - Ensure all local Café leads have access to current documentation and are operating in accordance with national standards.
  - Review and update policies periodically in line with operational learnings and strategic direction.
- **Financial Administration:**
  - Ensure all Café revenue is accurately recorded and reported in line with national financial guidelines.
  - Oversee the preparation of Café-related invoices for internal events and chargebacks.
  - Monitor Café financial performance against budget and flag variances to the National Admin BAPS Shayona and Finance team.